

Who Holds the Name? Package Authority, Repository Provenance and Delisting in the Official MCP Registry and in npm Packages Carrying MCP Keywords: Daily Measurements over Five Weeks (npm) and Ten Days (Registry)

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Preprint v6, 2026-09-03 · Dataset: <https://doi.org/10.5281/zenodo.22270727> (concept DOI 10.5281/zenodo.22251005)

Abstract

Security receipts and lockfile pins for Model Context Protocol (MCP) servers bind a verdict to a name and a version. They do not observe who can publish under the name, who holds the name in a registry, or where the declared source lives, and each of these can change while the pinned bytes stay the same. We measure such changes in two populations that only partly overlap: the official MCP registry (26,298 entries on 2026-09-02, diffed daily over ten days, 2026-08-23 to 09-02) and the npm packages that npm's search ranks highest for MCP-related keywords (3,287 packages on 2026-09-02, audited daily over five weeks, 2026-07-30 to 09-02; 631 of them are also declared by a registry entry). The diffs record 204 events on 199 distinct names. In the npm population, 42 maintainer-set changes were observed; by npm's own publish timestamps and each package's actual interval since its previous audit, 28 of 42 had no release inside that interval (66.7%, 95% CI [51.6, 79.0]), 20 had none within a day on either side of it and 10 had none within a week. Against a package-day baseline, maintainer-set changes are nevertheless strongly associated with release activity (rate ratio 4.4 for the audit interval, 2.4 for ± 7 days); on inspection they are dominated by additions and removals within scoped packages (23 additions, 11 removals, 3 whole-set replacements), and none is established as a transfer against an owner's intent. In the registry, 43 repository URL changes and 60 delistings were observed; repository changes coincide with a release on the documented publish path, and 39 of 60 delistings were renames or moves to another name, 19 of them naming a different namespace, which are the registry-name authority events this series can see. The published event feed de-duplicates repeated changes of a package while its latest version is unchanged; the crawl-state backups show 10 further maintainer-set changes on 6 packages in the window, so 42 is an undercount. An RDAP census of the 6,227 domains behind domain-based namespaces finds one domain unregistered, four in redemption and thirty in the auto-renew period, reported separately. A censoring-aware join with an independent runtime tool-inventory series (ATX) does not detect an excess of inventory changes around repository changes on the available overlap (4 of 10 vs. a 23.1% baseline, one-sided $P = 0.18$; a rate above about 68% would have been needed for 80% power), and no maintainer-set change can enter that join because the npm population lies almost entirely outside the registry. All shares are reported at daily observation resolution with their sensitivity to the observation boundary; none is a lower bound. Data, scripts, a signed daily manifest and OpenTimestamps proofs are published under CC BY 4.0.

1. Introduction

The official MCP registry (registry.modelcontextprotocol.io) lists servers under reverse-DNS names and points each entry to packages (npm, PyPI, OCI, MCPB, NuGet, Cargo) or remote endpoints, and optionally

to a source repository. Its moderation policy delegates security assessment downstream, and a draft extension for scanner receipts (registry PR #1404) binds a verdict to the digest of a scanned artifact. A digest-bound receipt is, by design, joinable across any event that leaves the artifact bytes unchanged. Three kinds of event do that while changing something a consumer of the receipt would want to know:

- Package authority: the set of accounts that may publish the package (on npm, the maintainer set).
- Registry-name authority: who may publish under the registry name — for `io.github.*` names the GitHub account bound at publish time, for domain-based names the domain proven by a DNS or HTTP challenge — and, observably, the registry's own record of a name being renamed, moved or deleted.
- Repository provenance: the repository URL that the entry or package declares as its source.

These layers are distinct and must not be conflated. An organisation that adds a colleague to its npm package changes the maintainer set without transferring anything; a project that moves its repository changes provenance without changing who holds the registry name; a domain that lapses changes who could claim registry-name authority without any change on npm. Earlier public statements of this series pooled the layers into one 'custody' rate; this note reports them separately, names each measured quantity by what was observed, and states in which population it was observed.

Two populations. The series combines a whole-population diff of the official registry with a daily audit of npm packages found through npm's search for MCP-related keywords. The two populations overlap only partly (Section 3.1): most npm packages carrying MCP keywords are not declared by any registry entry, and most registry entries declare no npm package that the search surfaces. This matters for every statement below: maintainer-set changes are a property of the npm population, delistings and namespace renames a property of the registry, and repository changes are observed in both.

Contributions. (1) A daily series of authority-layer events in both populations with, for every event, whether a release accompanied it — by detection in the same or an adjacent daily observation and, for maintainer-set changes, by npm's own publish timestamps against each package's actual audit interval and a package-day baseline. (2) A composition analysis of the maintainer-set changes and a classification of the repository changes, including the state of the old repository URL. (3) A classification of registry delistings by the registry's own status messages under a stated rule, which exposes renames and namespace moves as observable registry-name authority events. (4) An RDAP census of the domains behind domain-based namespaces, reported by registration status. (5) A censoring-aware join with an independent runtime tool-inventory series. (6) An open, signed and timestamped dataset with standard-library recount scripts for every number.

Non-claims. The note does not claim that any observed event was malicious, does not observe runtime tool definitions, and does not report lower bounds: observation times are interval-censored and every share is given with its sensitivity to the observation boundary.

2. Background: what the registry does and does not prove

An entry in the official registry is identified by a reverse-DNS name. Names under `io.github.*` are bound to a GitHub account at publish time (GitHub OAuth or OIDC); names under any other prefix are bound to a domain through a DNS TXT or HTTP challenge, and the API also accepts OIDC tokens from configured providers. On 2026-09-03, 18,073 of 26,544 listed entries (68.1%) were `io.github.*` names and the rest domain-based; no GitLab-based or `com.github.*` names were listed. Entries declared 8,323 npm, 3,532 PyPI, 1,000 MCPB, 857 OCI, 106 NuGet and 38 Cargo packages, and 14,867 entries declared remote endpoints. On the documented publish path, entry metadata including the repository URL is written by

publishing a new version of the entry; the API also exposes an edit endpoint for holders of edit permission, which is not part of the publish path and was not observed to be used. A deleted entry is not removed but marked with status deleted, a timestamp and an optional message, hidden from default listings and retrievable with `include_deleted=true`.

Two consequences frame the measurement. First, registry-name authority for domain-based names is only as durable as the domain registration: a lapsed domain can be re-registered by a third party who would then pass the same challenge. Second, nothing in the entry records package authority: the npm maintainer set is visible only on npm, and the registry does not re-verify it after publish. Package authority, registry-name authority and repository provenance therefore have different verifiers, lifetimes and failure modes, and a consumer who keys trust on name plus version sees none of them.

3. Data and method

3.1 Two populations, two crawls

- Registry population (wide crawl, since 2026-08-23). Every entry returned by the registry's public listing is diffed against the previous day's snapshot on the registry's own fields: latest version, repository URL, presence. The listing held 25,671 entries on 2026-08-30 and 26,298 at 01:40 UTC on 2026-09-02, growing by roughly 200–250 entries a day (a listing read at 09:20 UTC the same day for the census in Section 5.1 held 26,363). Observations: 05:00 UTC on 2026-08-23 (first run), 03:40 UTC (08-24 to 08-28), 01:40 UTC from 08-29, plus two manual runs on 2026-08-26 (17:58 and 18:01 UTC). The frozen series contains 10 daily diffs of the registry plus the two manual runs. This crawl is the source of `repo_changed`, `repo_removed` and `unpublished` (delisting) events for registry entries.
- npm population (deep crawl, since 2026-07-30). Package names are gathered from npm's search API for six keyword queries (`keywords:mcp`, `keywords:mcp-server`, `keywords:modelcontextprotocol`, `keywords:model-context-protocol`, `keywords:mcp-client`, `keywords:claude-mcp`), taking search-ranked results within a 4-minute discovery budget (2,660 names on 2026-09-02); each package is then read from the npm registry — maintainer set, published versions, existence — within a 25-minute audit budget at 4 concurrent requests. The tracked npm population grew from 985 packages on 2026-07-30 to 3,287 on 2026-09-02; 1,829 were audited on 2026-09-02, 2,181 distinct packages within the previous two days and 2,360 within seven, so a package's maintainer set is re-read most days but not every day. The same crawl also reads 164 registry entries that declare only remote endpoints, which is why one registry event (Section 4.3) predates the wide crawl. Observations: 03:10 UTC (2026-08-01 to 08-09), 03:30 UTC (08-10 to 08-28; 03:36 on 08-15), 01:33 UTC from 2026-08-29, plus one extra run on 2026-08-09 at 18:24 UTC; a separate daily audit of agent-skill registries writes to the same event feed about half an hour later under its own identifiers and does not observe npm packages.

Overlap. Of the 3,287 tracked npm packages, 631 (19.2%) are declared as the npm package of some registry entry; conversely, the registry declared 7,822 distinct npm identifiers on 2026-09-03, of which 8.1% are in the tracked npm population. The npm population is therefore neither a subset nor a sample of the registry: it is what npm's search ranks highest for MCP-related keywords — including client-side and generic MCP keywords, not only servers — and it is biased towards popular, well-described and recently published packages by construction of that ranking. Neither crawl missed a day in the study window; the event series was frozen at the 2026-09-02 observation.

3.2 Event types and their exact semantics

- `maintainer_changed` — the npm maintainer set of a tracked package differs from its previous audit. The published feed de-duplicates events by (name, type, latest version), so a second maintainer-set change of the same package while its latest version is unchanged is not recorded as a new event: the daily backups of the crawl state show 52 change points against the 42 recorded events — 10 suppressed changes on 6 packages, listed in the dataset (`audit_history_42.json`) — so the count of 42 is an undercount of maintainer-set changes by about a fifth. Package-authority layer; npm population only (41 of 42 on packages outside the registry; the one exception is `@postman/postman-mcp-server`, whose registry entry declares 4 authenticated remote endpoints).
- `repo_changed` — the declared repository URL differs from the previous observation, after normalisation of scheme, `git+` prefix, `.git` suffix, trailing slash and case; the 77 events include no purely cosmetic change. Repository-provenance layer; 43 events on registry entries and 34 on npm packages (9 of which are also registry packages).
- `repo_removed` — the repository field disappeared (23 registry entries, 2 npm packages).
- `unpublished` — the entry is no longer returned by the registry listing. All 60 such events are registry entries whose status the registry reports as deleted when queried with `include_deleted=true`; 50 of the 60 declare only remote endpoints, 8 declare an npm package, 1 a PyPI package and 1 neither. No npm-level removal was observed. The registry's `statusChangedAt` timestamps fall 0.5 to 23.3 hours (median 8.7) before the observation that detected each delisting and never after it, which validates the detection procedure for this layer.

Registry-name authority is observed through the delisting messages (renames and moves between names, Section 4.4) and through the RDAP census (Section 5.1); it is not observable as a field diff because the registry does not expose the account or domain binding.

3.3 Accompaniment: detection-based and timestamp-based

A change is accompanied when a release of the same package or entry occurs close to it in time; an accompanied change is the case a digest-bound receipt or a version pin does see. Two definitions are used.

- Detection-based (all layers). A `version_published` event is recorded when the latest version read at the snapshot differs from the previous snapshot (for npm packages, the version npm reports as latest; prereleases not tagged latest are not detected). A change is accompanied if a `version_published` event for the same name is recorded in the same daily observation (flag `sameDayVersionPublished`) or in the same or an adjacent observation (flag `versionInAdjacentObservation`). Both the change and the release are inferred by diffing consecutive snapshots, so their true times are interval-censored to the detection interval, and a change and a release on different sides of a snapshot boundary are recorded as unaccompanied under the first flag even if minutes apart. Shares are therefore reported at daily observation resolution and are not lower bounds; the second flag shows the sensitivity to the boundary.
- Timestamp-based (maintainer-set changes only). For each of the 42 maintainer-set changes, npm's time map was read on 2026-09-03 and every version's publish timestamp compared with the package's actual audit interval — from the package's previous audit, reconstructed from the daily backups of the crawl state, to the audit that recorded the change (9.1 to 168.0 hours; median 24.0; 6 intervals longer than 30 hours because the package had not been audited on the previous day) — and with that interval widened by 24 hours on both sides and by 7 days on both sides. This removes the censoring of release times; the time of the maintainer-set change itself remains censored to the interval, because npm exposes the current maintainer set but not when it changed, which is why the widened windows are reported alongside the interval.

- **Baseline.** To interpret the shares, the same windows were evaluated for every (package, day) pair of the tracked npm population over the 33 days of the series ($3,321 \text{ packages} \times 33 \text{ days} = 109,593 \text{ package-days}$): the share of package-days with a release on the same day, within ± 1 day and within ± 7 days. The baseline counts every tracked package on every day, including days before a package entered the population and days on which it was not audited, whereas a maintainer-set change can only be observed on an audited day and the audited subset is ranked by a search that rewards recent publication; in addition, the numerator counts every version by npm timestamp (prereleases and several releases per interval included) while the baseline counts only changes of the latest version by detection, and the interval row compares audit intervals of up to 168 hours with calendar days; the rate ratios below are therefore biased upwards by an amount this note cannot quantify, and should be read as indicative.

3.4 Statistics

Shares carry Wilson 95% intervals. Rate ratios divide a share of maintainer-set changes by the corresponding baseline share, with a log-normal (Katz) interval that treats the baseline as a constant; its own Wilson interval is narrower than 0.6 points and package-days within a package are correlated, so the treatment is a simplification rather than a claim of independence. The join in Section 5.2 uses a one-sided exact binomial test against the baseline and reports the minimum rate detectable with 80% power at the observed sample size instead of post-hoc power.

3.5 Integrity of the series

Each day's dataset manifest (sha256 and byte size of every series file) is signed with an Ed25519 key (key id a5012532089482c0) published at pulsefeed.dev/.well-known/manifest-signing-key.json and timestamped into Bitcoin through 3 OpenTimestamps calendars; the manifest bytes that are hashed, signed and published are byte-identical. A valid signature proves that PulseFeed published the bytes and the proof shows when they existed; neither certifies that the data are correct.

4. Results

4.1 Overview

204 events on 199 distinct names between 2026-08-01 (first diff) and 2026-09-02, by layer, type and population (Table 1). Types are not pooled across layers or populations: their denominators, windows and meanings differ. The pooled figure over all four types used in earlier public statements of this series is not reported here and is not in the dataset.

Table 1. Events by layer, type and population, with detection-based release accompaniment.

Layer	Type	Registry entries	npm packages	No release in same observation	No release in same or adjacent observation
Package authority	maintainer_changed	0	42 (1 also in registry)	32 (76.2%)	23 (54.8%)
Repository provenance	repo_changed	43	34 (9 also in registry)	1 (artifact, see 4.3)	1 (artifact, see 4.3)
Repository provenance	repo_removed	23	2	0	0
Registry-name authority / delisting	unpublished (status deleted)	60	0	not applicable	57 (3 with an adjacent release)

Wilson 95% intervals for the maintainer_changed shares: same observation [61.5, 86.5], same or adjacent [39.9, 68.8]. Registry rows cover ten daily diffs (2026-08-23 to 09-02); the npm rows cover 33.

4.2 Package authority: maintainer-set changes in the npm population

Composition. Of the 42 maintainer-set changes, 23 only added accounts, 11 only removed accounts, 5 did both and 3 replaced the entire set. 36 of the 42 packages are scoped (@scope/name); the median set size was 3 accounts before and 3 after, and 11 packages had a single maintainer before the change. The 3 whole-set replacements are the only events with the form of a handover — one sole maintainer replaced by another sole maintainer — and by npm timestamps each sits next to a release: vision-relay had a release inside its 24-hour interval, sunpeak a release 9.8 hours before its interval, and @babylonjs/mcp-servers a release inside its 142-hour interval (the package had not been audited for six days). No event in the set was established as a transfer against the owner's intent.

Table 2. Maintainer-set changes and releases by npm publish timestamps against each package's audit interval (n = 42), with the package-day baseline.

Window	Release present	No release	Share without release (95% CI)	Baseline: package-days with a release	Rate ratio (95% CI)
Audit interval (median 24 h)	14	28	66.7% [51.6, 79.0]	7.6% (same day)	4.40 [2.87, 6.75]
Interval ± 24 h	22	20	47.6% [33.4, 62.3]	15.0% (±1 day)	3.50 [2.62, 4.67]
Interval ± 7 days	32	10	23.8% [13.5, 38.5]	32.0% (±7 days)	2.38 [2.01, 2.82]

Agreement with the detection-based same-observation flag: 38 of 42; the four disagreements are 3 prerelease publishes and 1 stable release (@aikidosec/mcp) that the detection path did not record. Rate ratios are biased upwards (Section 3.3).

Reading. Two things are true at once. Most maintainer-set changes are not accompanied by a release within the audit interval in which they were detected (28 of 42), about half within a two-day tolerance and about a quarter within a week. And maintainer-set changes are far more likely than an arbitrary package-day to sit next to a release: 4.4 times the baseline within the interval, 2.4 times within a week. The first statement sizes the blind spot of a version-keyed consumer; the second says that the changes are, in the main, part of release-time maintenance rather than isolated events. For the 28 changes without a release inside the interval, the nearest release lay a median 108 hours away (nearest-rank quartiles 19 and 463 hours, maximum 10,427 hours), before the interval in 25 cases and after it in 3.

Persistence. On 2026-09-03 the current maintainer set still equalled the recorded post-change set for 31 of the 42 events; the other 11 had changed again by that date; by the crawl-state backups 7 packages changed

their maintainer set more than once within the window (mcp-remote and @runpod/mcp-server each appear twice among the 42 events; the other repeats were suppressed by the feed's de-duplication, Section 3.2), consistent with ongoing organisational churn.

The one staged transfer. The most widely installed package in the set, mcp-remote, shows the sequence a cooperative transfer produces: on 2026-08-22 the two existing maintainers {geelen, threepointone} added a third account (punkpeye), with releases 0.1.39 to 0.1.43 inside the interval; on 2026-08-26 the set became that account alone, again with releases (0.2.2 to 0.2.5) inside the interval, and the declared repository moved from geelen/mcp-remote to punkpeye/mcp-remote the same day; the old repository URL now returns HTTP 301 to the new one, and version 0.8.3 was published on 2026-08-31 through GitHub Actions under the new sole maintainer's authority. This is a transfer of package authority and repository provenance established by the sequence itself and accompanied by releases at every step; the series records it and makes no claim about intent.

4.3 Repository provenance: repository URL changes

Of the 77 repository URL changes, 40 moved to a different repository under the same owner, 33 moved to a different owner string and 4 involved a host other than GitHub. For the 33 owner changes the old URL was checked on 2026-09-03: 15 redirect (HTTP 301) to the new owner, consistent with a GitHub transfer or account rename; 14 return 404; 4 are still live, consistent with a fork adopted as canonical. 27 of the 33 kept the repository name. Whether the controlling party changed was established for none of them; the series records where the declared source moved, not why.

Accompaniment here follows from the systems rather than from behaviour: on the documented publish path a registry entry's repository URL is written by publishing a new version, and an npm package's repository field is read from the version tagged latest. (Both have side paths: the registry's edit endpoint for holders of edit permission, which the wide crawl would record as a repository change without a version change and which was not observed; and moving npm's latest tag to an existing version, which the detection-based flag cannot distinguish from a release and which was therefore not tested for.) 76 of 77 changes accordingly coincided with a release in the same observation. The single exception (ai.bowmark/bowmark, detected on the first diff, bowmark-ai/skill → Metroxe/bowmark) contradicts the registry's own version history, in which Metroxe/bowmark appears on 23 versions published up to 2026-06-06 and bowmark-ai/skill on the 688 versions published since, several per day; it is classified as an observation artifact of the first diff rather than as a silent change. Repository provenance is therefore the layer in which a version-keyed consumer sees every change by construction of the publish path; what it does not see is where the source went.

4.4 Registry-name authority through delistings

All 60 delistings are registry entries with status deleted. The registry's status messages, read on 2026-09-03, were classified by a stated rule — the first matching word-boundary pattern among renamed/moved/superseded, retired/withdrawn/discontinued, paused/suspended — and a delisting names a different namespace when its message mentions a reverse-DNS namespace other than the entry's own followed by a name or the word namespace (bare hostnames do not count); the patterns and every message are in the dataset. 39 were renamed or moved to another name, 19 of them naming a different namespace (for example from an io.github.* name to a domain-based name after DNS verification, or into an organisation's io.github.* namespace); 14 were retired or withdrawn; 3 were paused pending a commercial condition; 4 carried no message. The cross-namespace moves are the registry-name authority events this series can see directly: the same server continues under a name that a different account or domain controls. Delisting does not free the old name — the namespace stays bound to the same account or domain — so

these are moves, not releases of a name. The three delistings with a release detected in an adjacent observation are not renames-and-republishes: one was retired within an hour of publication, one migrated to another name, and one carried no message.

Table 3. Registry delistings by status message under the stated rule (n = 60).

Reason	Entries	Layer
Renamed or moved to another name	39	registry-name authority (19 name a different namespace)
Retired or withdrawn	14	delisting
Paused	3	delisting
No message	4	unclassified

50 of the 60 declare only remote endpoints; 8 declare an npm package, 1 a PyPI package, 1 neither. Detection lag from statusChangedAt: 0.5–23.3 h, median 8.7 h, never negative.

5. Two complementary measurements

5.1 Registry-name authority: RDAP census of namespace domains

For domain-based names the registry proves publish rights by domain control, so registry-name authority depends on the domain's registration status. On 2026-09-02 (09:20–09:55 UTC) the listing held 26,363 entries; 17,992 were io.github.* names (out of scope) and 8,193 were under purchasable domains, reduced by the Public Suffix List to 6,227 unique registrable domains; 178 entries on subdomains of 22 shared domains (hosting providers and one API domain) were excluded after their parent domains were found registered. Each domain was queried once at its TLD registry's RDAP service (IANA bootstrap plus manually located endpoints for .io, .me, .sh, .de, .ch, .so and .us; rdap.org for the rest) with an independent DNS delegation check, and the classification was recounted by a second script that ships with the dataset. Statuses differ materially and are reported separately (Table 4).

Table 4. Domains behind domain-based namespaces by RDAP status, 2026-09-02.

Status	Domains	Entries	What it establishes
Unregistered (registry RDAP 404; DNS NXDOMAIN)	1	2	available for registration today
Redemption period or pending delete	4	10	expired; becomes available if not restored
Auto-renew period (registry status)	30	31	renewed by the registry pending payment; enters redemption if unpaid; looks current by expiry date
Expiring within 30 days	62	64	registered; 55 carry registrar transfer locks, 2 expired on the census day
clientHold	2	2	registered, locked by the registrar
Registered and not expiring within 30 days	5,786	7,608	124 of these report no expiry date
ccTLD without RDAP (delegated in DNS)	342	476	not checked beyond delegation

Only the unregistered domain is established as available. A registrar transfer lock says nothing about the registrant's intention to renew. The domain list was filed through the registry's private vulnerability reporting (GHSA-88rj-x86r-6589) rather than published; the aggregate was posted as a comment on registry issue #1500, itself a deletion request for entries whose publisher no longer controls the verifying domain.

5.2 Do repository changes coincide with runtime inventory changes?

ATX (atxregistry.org) independently observes the tool inventory of remote MCP endpoints seeded from the registry, rescanning at a median interval of 2.05 days. Per the export's documentation [7], 17% of hostnames opt out through robots.txt and are excluded, and tool descriptions are truncated at 500 characters before hashing, so its drift counts are lower bounds. Its per-endpoint export for 2026-08-12 to 2026-08-31 (29,584 observations, 6,033 endpoints, 4,027 hosts) is published with checksums. The inventory hash definition widened on 2026-08-26 to include descriptions and annotations, so hashes were compared only within one definition version. The join is censoring-aware: the ATX observation before an event must precede the registry observation that preceded the detection, so that it cannot post-date the change itself, and the observation after must follow the detection.

Funnel. 119 maintainer-set or repository changes; 24 outside the ATX window and 95 inside it; of those, 50 are on npm packages that no registry entry declares and cannot be joined, 45 carry a registry name; 13 of the 45 are in the ATX population; of the 13, 3 had no usable bracketing pair (in all three the only candidate pair straddled the hash-definition change), leaving 10 bracketed events, all repository changes. Inventory changed across 4 of the 10 (40.0%, 95% CI [16.8, 68.7]) against a baseline of 4,061 of 17,595 consecutive same-version pairs (23.1%); the one-sided binomial probability of at least 4 of 10 under the baseline is 0.18. At $n = 10$ the test rejects the baseline only from 6 of 10 upwards, and 80% power would require a true rate of about 68%; the data neither show nor exclude a moderate excess.

Structure. No maintainer-set change enters this join: 50 of the 95 in-window events are on npm packages outside the registry, and the one maintainer-set change on a registry package (@postman/postman-mcp-server) declares authenticated remote endpoints that are not in the ATX population. Package authority is a property of the npm population, runtime inventory a property of publicly reachable remote endpoints, and the two barely intersect; the series are complements, not cross-checks of each other.

6. Threats to validity

- **Construct.** A maintainer-set change is not an established transfer of control; a repository URL change is not a change of registry-name authority; a delisting is a status change, not a freed name. The layers are reported separately and named by what was observed; Sections 4.2–4.4 are what stand between the numbers and an over-reading.
- **Population.** The npm population is what npm's search ranks highest for six MCP-related keywords within a time budget — including client and generic MCP keywords — not the registry's packages and not a random sample; it favours popular, well-described and recently published packages. Only 19% of it is declared by a registry entry, and only 8% of the registry's npm identifiers are in it. Statements about package authority therefore describe npm packages carrying MCP keywords, not the registry.
- **Exposure.** The tracked npm population tripled during the window, and about 1,829 of 3,287 packages are audited on a given day within the budget; the audit intervals behind Table 2 are reconstructed from daily backups of the crawl state. The 42 events are counts over a growing, partially observed population, and the rate ratios are biased upwards (Section 3.3).
- **Completeness.** The feed's de-duplication suppresses repeated maintainer-set changes of a package with an unchanged latest version (10 of 52 change points in the window); the 42 events are the recorded subset, and every share in Table 2 is a share of that subset.
- **Censoring.** Detection-based accompaniment is interval-censored (Section 3.3); the timestamp-based analysis removes the censoring of release times but not of the change times. For registry entries the

registry's own timestamps (`statusChangedAt`; the `updated_since` change feed) could remove the censoring entirely; this note used them only to validate the delisting lag.

- Coverage of registry-name authority. The RDAP census covers domain-based names only; the 68.1% of the registry under `io.github.*` was not examined for reclaimable accounts (the method of Li and Gao [3]). The delisting classification depends on free-text messages and a regular-expression rule; the rule and every message are published so that a different rule can be applied.
- RDAP. A snapshot; 342 ccTLD domains are unchecked, 124 registered domains report no expiry date, and registrar practice around expiry varies by TLD.
- Statistics. Ten bracketed events in the ATX join; the minimum detectable rate at that size is reported instead of post-hoc power. Five weeks is a first estimate of every rate.

7. Related work

Santos-Grueiro [1] introduces release-authority measurement for registry-mediated ecosystems (npm, PyPI, Maven Central, crates.io, RubyGems): transitions in the public authority path of a release, such as a new publisher account, a repository relink or a provenance change, that expose a release-time review surface before payload evidence exists. The MCP registry adds a layer those ecosystems lack, a name bound to an account or a domain; this note measures that layer alongside package authority and repository provenance and, for package authority, does so in a keyword-defined npm population rather than in the registry. Bharti [2] reconstructs 120 observations over 88.6 days covering 19,099 distinct entries and measures how unevenly registry descriptions go stale by content hash, noting that content hashes do not observe ownership; the present series addresses that axis on the same registry. Li and Gao [3] present a cross-entity security study of MCP from a snapshot of six registries (67,057 servers, June–July 2025), finding weak vetting and ownership checks at the registry level, 304 redirected GitHub accounts that could be reclaimed and 139 resubmissions under renamed accounts; the daily series here turns the delisting and rename part of that picture into a rate on the official registry. Guo et al. [4] measure six MCP marketplaces (17,630 entries, 8,401 valid projects) and ask whether marketplace growth is inflated by placeholders and abandoned prototypes. The registry's draft scan-receipt extension [5] documents name custody as a scope boundary, and an OSV schema proposal for agent skills and MCP servers [6] discusses how such ecosystems would be identified; both discussions used the live version of this series and the corrections it went through.

8. Ethics, reproducibility and availability

All data were collected from public registries by read-only requests at low rates; no server was probed beyond metadata. The list of lapsed or unregistered namespace domains is directly actionable by an attacker and was reported privately to the registry maintainers through GitHub's vulnerability reporting; only aggregates appear here. Package, entry and account names cited as examples are already public in the registries concerned, and no intent is attributed to any of them.

Dataset (this version): <https://doi.org/10.5281/zenodo.22270727> — the events with population and both accompaniment flags (JSON, CSV), the npm timestamp check with each package's reconstructed audit interval, the delisting status check with the classification rule and every message, the old-URL check for owner changes, the ATX join script and result with the observation times and identifier map it uses, the package-day baseline inputs and script, the RDAP census scripts, extraction statistics and recount script (the per-domain classification is withheld), a facts file with the source of every number, standard-library recount scripts, the signed daily manifest and OpenTimestamps proofs, and a README with limits;

concept DOI for all versions <https://doi.org/10.5281/zenodo.22251005> (CC BY 4.0). Live series: <https://pulsefeed.dev/evidence/name-custody.json> (moving; cite the DOI). Daily manifests, signatures and proofs: <https://pulsefeed.dev/anchors/latest.json>. ATX export: <https://atxregistry.org/exports/capability-observations-2026-09-02.jsonl.gz>.

Disclosure. Text drafting was assisted by a large language model. Every number in this note was produced by the described scripts, recomputed by a second independent script, and checked by the author against the published files; the author takes full responsibility for the content.

References

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